TENSES

THE SIMPLE PRESENT TENSE

It is used to express habitual actions or general truths.

EXAMPLE

1. He ***brushes*** his teeth after each meal.
2. The earth ***is*** a planet

It is used to refer to something which is happening at the moment of speaking if there is no absolute necessity to stress the continuity of the action.

EXAMPLE

1. The government ***tries*** to instill national pride among the people

EXERCISE 1

Change the verbs in brackets to simple present tense

EXAMPLE: My brother (live) in Zimbabwe.

My brother ***lives*** in Zimbabwe

1. Sam (play) tennis and cricket. He (enjoy) both games.
2. The river (overflow) its banks and (flood) the village.
3. He (leave) for Gaborone tonight. The bus (be) at nine o'clock.
4. She (go) to the cinema every week.
5. My sister (like) to listen to the radio every morning.
6. We (depart) for Kasane tomorrow.
7. He (know) who (be) responsible but he will not tell me.
8. Mary often (say) her brother Tom (be) a fool.
9. Dogs (make) good pets because they (be) friendly and faithful.
10. Naledi (hate) people who are dishonest.

THE PRESENT CONTINOUS TENSE

- It is used to refer to action that is going on at the moment of speaking.

Example

The baby is crying loudly.

- It is used to express a definite action planned for the immediate future.

Example

He is going to college.

- It is used to refer to an action happening now but not necessarily at the moment of speaking

Example

I am learning a new language.

EXERCISE 2

Put the verbs in brackets in simple present or present continuous tense

Example

I (look) for Peter. He (have) my badminton racket.

I **am looking** for Peter. He **has** my badminton racket.

1. The national swimmers (train) for two hours every day.
2. Look the man (jump) off the roof.
3. The book he (read) (belong) to me.
4. I always (get) up before the sun (rise)
5. Jane (wash) dishes in the kitchen.

THE SIMPLE PAST TENSE

It refers to action that took place in the past at a definite time during or a specific period of time.

Example

I ***received*** the letter yesterday.

He ***was*** a police officer for five years.

- ❖ It refers to a past habit.

She always ***took*** a banana for breakfast.

EXERCISE 3

1. The bomb (explodes) when the workers were out for lunch.
2. We (hear) footsteps and wonder who can be up so late.
3. She (answers) quickly when he asked about the money.
4. He (does) what he thought was right.
5. The plane (crush) and (kill) all the passengers.
6. Thabo and his mother (have) only one cow.
7. I (walk) to school every day when I was a child.
8. She (want) to buy the shoes last week.

THE PAST CONTINOUS TENSE

It is used to refer to actions continuing at some time in the past.

I ***was waiting*** for the bus when he saw me.

EXERCISE 4

FILL IN EACH BLANK WITH THE PAST CONTNIOUS TENSE OF THE VERB IN BRACKETS WHERE POSSIBLE. OTHERWISE USE SIMPLE PAST TENSE

1. I (go) ____ to work yesterday as my car (is) ___ in the garage.
2. He told us he (work) ___ in a farm and we (can) ___ always visit him.
3. The plane (fly) ____ up in the sky yesterday.
4. Joseph (work) in a bank when I met him three years ago.
5. The man (slip) ____ away while the crowd (watch) ____ the clown.

THE FUTURE TENSE

The simple future is used to refer to an action in the future. It can be expressed with the use of helping verbs ***shall*** for first person and ***will*** for second and third persons.

EXAMPLES

We **shall visit** Maun next year.

You ***will see*** me at the conference.

- It is also used to express something that will be continuing to happen at some particular time in the future.

Example

We ***shall be working*** hard at our desks when you arrive at 10 a.m.

She ***will be cooking*** dinner when her husband returns from work.

EXERCISE 5

FOR EACH SENTENCE PUT ONE OF THE VERBS IN BRACKETS IN THE SIMPLE FUTURE AND THE OTHER IN THE CONTINOUS TENSE

1. Mary (attend) the party tonight. She (wear) her new dress.
2. I (be) at home the whole morning. I (help) my mother with cleaning of the house.
3. My friend (arrive) by train at seven o'clock. I (wait) for him at the station.
4. My mother (shop) on Sunday. She (buy) me a pair of sneakers.
5. I (be) back in half an hour. You (stay) until then?
6. I (not be) awake when you leave in the morning. I (sleep).

THE PRESENT PERFECT TENSE

It refers to action completed at an unspecified time in the past but which has an effect on the present. The emphasis is on the fact that the action has been achieved rather than on the time it took place.

EXAMPLE

- I ***have seen*** the movie.
- Neo **has completed** her final examination.

It also refers to an action that began in the past and is still continuing in the present or has just finished. The emphasis is on the fact of its duration up to the present, and not on its present activity.

EXAMPLE

- He ***has lived*** in this village for six years.
- We ***have discussed*** about this point since 7 pm.

The present perfect continuous tense may be used instead of the present perfect without any change meaning.

- He ***has been living*** in this village for six years.
- We ***have been discussing*** about this point since 7pm.

EXERCISE 6

CHOOSE THE CORRECT TENSE FROM THE BRACKETS

1. I am pleased that you (made, have made) good progress. Keep it up
2. She (failed, has failed) her music examination last year.
3. The letter (arrived, has arrived) three days ago.
4. I (watered, have watered) the plants, you do not have to do it today.
5. The police have (questioned, have been questioning) the thief since morning.

THE PAST PERFECT TENSE

It is used to relate one past action to another action or to a point of time in the past. The earlier of the two actions, or the action which is earlier than the point of time in the past, should be in the past perfect tense. The other action is in the simple past tense.

EXAMPLE

- The family ***had finished*** supper when I got home.
- Pitso ***had completed*** his homework by 5 o'clock.

The past perfect continuous tense is used to express an action which began at a certain time in the past and was still continuing or had just finished at another point of time in the past.

- He ***had been working*** as a comedian when he was offered a role in a film.
- She grew thin because ***she had not been*** eating well for weeks.

EXERCISE 7

FILL IN THE BLANKS WITH THE PAST PERFECT TENSE OF THE VERB IN BRACKETS

1. She had a headache in the morning because she ____ (not sleep) the previous night.
2. The letter ____ (deliver) to the wrong addresses when it finally reached me.

3. He said he _____ (forget) to feed the dog.
4. After Boipelo_____ (drive) for an hour, he asked me to take over the wheel.
5. The trip _____ (plan) several weeks before.
6. When she got to the library, she found that the book _____ (borrow) by someone else.

THE FUTURE PERFECT TENSE

It refers to an action which will have been completed at a particular point of time in the future. It is always used with time expression.

EXAMPLE

- In two years' time, he ***will have finished*** his training as a coach.

The future perfect continuous tense refers to an action which will have been continuing for a period of time by a particular point of time in the future.

- By Tuesday I ***shall have been*** waiting for a reply for two weeks.

EXERCISE 8

CHOOSE THE CORRECT WORD TO COMPLETE THE SENTENCES FROM THE BRACKETS

1. We hope you (will have finished/ will be finishing five chapters by tomorrow.
2. After he___ (had studied/has studied) medicine for three years, he ____(give/gave) it up.
3. We ___(are/were) very tired; we _____(have been working/had been working) on the land the whole morning
4. Last month he ___ (married/had married) the girl whom he ___ (was courting/had been courting) for five years.

NOUNS

COLLECTIVE NOUNS

They are used to refer to collections or groups of animals, persons or things.

EXAMPLES

- A bunch of bananas/grapes
- A sheaf of arrow/corn
- A brood of chickens
- A flock of sheep/birds
- A fleet of motor cars /ships
- A team of players/oxen/horses
- A pack of rascals/wolves
- A flight of doves/swallows
- A pride of lions

EXERCISE 9

COMPLETE WITH THE CORRECT COLLECTIVE NOUN

1. Naledi was bitten by _____of bees.
2. Our school has a _____ of beautiful girls.
3. My uncles' store was robbed by a ____of thieves.
4. The ____ of players from Kasane lost the game
5. We saw a large ____ of lions in the Chobe National Park
6. My brother has a large ____ of doves.
7. We bought a ____ of bananas from the supermarket.

PLURAL OF NOUNS

- Plural of nouns are usually formed by the addition of "s" or "es", and sometimes with other changes made in the spelling of the words.

ADDING –S	**ADDING –ES**	**ENDS IN F OR FE (REMOVE F, ADD -VES**
• Tour- tours	match - matches	leaf- leaves
• Car – cars	bus – buses	wolf- wolves
• House –houses	dish – dishes	life- lives
• Apple- apples	quiz –quizzes	knife – knives. (exceptions cliff-cliffs)

- Some nouns have plural forms in the singular and the plural.
  - Deer, sheep, swine, elk, salmon, water.
- Some nouns have plural forms involving a change of vowels or the addition of a syllable.

Man- men foot- feet mouse – mice child –children ox- oxen

PRONOUNS

PERSONAL PRONOUNS

They replace nouns which refer directly to persons and are of two kinds, those acting s subjects and those that are objects in sentences.

Personal pronouns that are subjects are**: I, you, he, she, he, it, we and they.**

Personal pronouns that are objects are; **me, you, him, her, it, us and them**

POSSESSIVE PRONOUNS

They are used to show possession. **Mine, yours, his, hers and theirs** are possessive pronouns.

DEMONSTRATIVE PRONOUNS

These are used to point to the nouns they replace. Demonstrative pronouns are **this, that, these and those.**

RELATIVE PRONOUNS

A relative pronoun is used to introduce a subordinate adjective clause and relates it to the noun or pronoun in the main clause. Examples of relative pronouns are **who, whom, whose, that and which.**

EXAMPLE

1. I have briefed the players **who** will start the game.
2. This is the girl **whose** shoes I found.
3. This is the dog **which** ate my food.
4. The plans **that** are made for the party are great.
5. The students **whom** you asked to see are here.

INTERROGATIVE PRONOUNS

These are pronouns that are used to ask questions and they are **who, whom, whose, which and what**.

EXAMPLES

- Who started the fight?
- Whom did you ask to assist you?
- What was happening here?
- Which is the shortest way to school?
- Whose is this bright idea?

INDEFINITE PRONOUNS

They are used to refer to people or things in general way. Some of the common indefinite pronouns are **someone, somebody, something, anyone, anybody, anything, everybody, everyone, everything, nobody, nothing, none ,each, some, both, all, several, few, many, much, more, little, less, another, other, others, e. t. c.**

ADJECTIVES

These are words that describe all tells us more about another word. All colors are adjectives. Examples of adjectives include: **fast, big, rude, funny, striped, wonderful, beautiful, proud, tall, fat, quiet, strange, gigantic, happy, kind, grateful, considerate ,childish, pleasant, awful, tight, better, comfortable, e.t.c**

EXERCISE

COMPLETE THE FOLLOWING SENTENCES USING ADJECTIVES BELOW

Wrong, happy, cold , useful, quiet, rude, funny

1. The water is too _____ for the baby's bath.
2. We got lost when we took the _____ path.
3. This hammer is very _____.
4. It was _____ in the classroom while we were reading.
5. Boitshepo had to apologize to his mother after his was ___
6. We all laughed at Grandfather's _____ story.
7. I feel ____ when the sun shines.

COMPARATIVES AND SUPERLATIVES

- We use ***comparative*** form of an adjective to compare two things. We add ***ER. We*** use the ***superlative*** form to compare three or more things. We add –***EST***.

BASIC FORM	**COMPARATIVE(-er) more**	**SUPERLATIVE(-est)most**
1. Green	greener	Greenest
2. Fast	Faster	fastest
3. Small	Smaller	Smallest
4. Beautiful	More beautiful	Most beautiful
5. Good	Better	best

EXERCISE

COMPLETE THE SENTENCES BY USING THE CORRECT FORM OF ADJECTIVES IN BRACKETS

1. Leago is (tall) than me but Thabo s the (tall) in the class.
2. Sega and Mary are (old) than Joyce who is the (young) in the family.
3. Football is (exciting) than history.
4. The elephant has the (long) nose.
5. Pretty looks (happy) than the last time I saw her.
6. The peacock is the (beautiful) bird I have ever seen.
7. One leg is (short) than the others.
8. This is the (useful) book I know.

ADVERBS

Adverbs are words that tell us more about a verb an adjective and even a whole clause or sentence. Adverbs usually express time, place, manner, frequency or degree.

EXAMPLES

1. They arrived **now**. (time)
2. He stood **there** alone. (place)
3. Everyone looked at her **sadly** as the coffin went down. (manner)
4. We **often** eat out. (frequency)
5. She **almost** slipped on the pavement. (degree)

Most of the adverbs are formed by adding –ly or –ily to adjectives.

- Wrong – wrongly
- Happy- happily
- Slow- slowly
- Hard- hardly
- Quick-quickly

EXERCISE

WRITE THESE SENTENCES USING THE ADVERBS BELOW TO FILL IN THE BLANKS

Successfully, slowly, neatly, quickly, hungrily, angrily

1. Run___ or you will be late for school.
2. The bus went _____ up the steep hill.
3. Pako managed to carry out the task _____
4. The thin dogs looked at the meat_____
5. Joshua had to write out his work again ____
6. Mr Brown shouted ____ at the herdboys.

SENTENCES

There are three types of sentences namely;

- Simple sentences
- Compound sentences
- Complex sentences

Simple sentences

Simple sentences consist of a subject and predicate. The subject is what is discussed in the sentence and the predicate expresses something about the subject. The subject is either a noun or pronoun together with ant modifying words or phrase associated with it. The predicate consists of the verb and other words such as objects and adverbs.

Examples of simple sentences

- He must rest for a few days.
- My mother is cooking soup and meat
- It is very cold today.
- They enjoyed the show.

Compound sentences

A compound sentence consists of two or more co-ordinate clauses joined by a co-coordinating conjunction such as **and**, **but, or, for, so, yet**, or by correlative conjunctions such as **either…. Or, neither….nor, both… and** and **not only**….**but…also**. Two or simple sentences may be combined to form a compound sentence by using the above conjunctions.

EXAMPLES

- He wanted a partner for the trip. No one wanted to go. He had to go alone.
- He wanted a partner for the trip ***but*** no one wanted to go, ***so*** he had to go alone.

EXERCISE

COMBINE EACH PAIR OF SENTENCES INTO COMPOUND SENTENCE USING *and, but, or, for* or ***so***

1. He tried to show off. No one was impressed.
2. The job is difficult. He is happy at it. He likes challenges.
3. Drive carefully. The road has sharp bends. There are many heavy vehicles.
4. She sat for the examination again. She was able to pass this time.
5. It was very late. Peter ha not finished his work. He decided to carry on.

COMPLEX SENTENCES

Two or more simple sentences may be combined into a complex sentence by using subordinating conjunctions.

- She apologized. Everyone is still angry with her.
- ***Although*** she apologized everyone is still angry with her.

EXERCISE

COMBINE EACH GROUP OF SENTENCES INTO COMPLEX SENTENCES USING SURBODINATING CONJUNCTIONS FROM THE GIVEN LIST

Although, as, if, before, unless, when, until, as if, because, so that, when, whether

1. You may use the room. The next class comes.
2. The child had not seen her parents for three years. She recognized them.
3. She had a headache. She could not enjoy himself at the party.
4. You call me. You are in trouble. I can help you.
5. You explain the problem to her. She will not understand.
6. I do not know. He is the culprit.
7. The villagers tried to put out the fire. The fire engine came.

PREPOSITIONS

Prepositions relate a noun or pronoun to another word in the same sentence. It usually tells where something is, where something is going on, or when something is happening. A preposition always introduces a phrase. The most common prepositions **are at, by, from, for, from, in, of, on, to , with, between, beside, over, after etc.**

Complete sentences below with the correct preposition.

1. The cups are _____ the sink.
2. Candy went to church ____ Kabelo.
3. Mary ran ___ to her mother.
4. The cat ran ___ the mouse.

5. The milk is ___ the fridge.
6. We travelled to the city ___ bus.
7. Tefo ran___ the street to catch a bus.
8. The football team starts practice ___ Monday.
9. We ate eggs and bread ___ break.
10. The clinic is ___ the corner of the school.

CONJUNCTIONS

Conjunctions are words that join words, phrases, clauses and sentences.

EXAMPLES OF CONJUNCTIONS

And, but, nor, so, or, yet, after, although, as, as if, because, before, for, if, once, since, so, so that, than, though, until, unless, when, whenever, whether, while, also, rather, except, although etc.

EXERCISE

COMPLETE WITH THE SUITABLE CONJUNCTION

1. Lebo speaks both Setswana___ English.
2. The kids came late ___ baked a cake.
3. I can neither eat ___drink before I play soccer.
4. I went to the stadium ___ the game was cancelled.
5. I cannot go ___ she comes
6. Mother came home ___ the work was done.
7. Coffee is just as good ____ tea.
8. Do you like sport ___ drama?

PUNCTUATION MARKS AND SOME OF THEIR USES

APOSTROPHE ‘

1. Shows possession
   - The girls’ toys
   - Naledi’s bag
2. Shows contractions
   - Can’t, she’s, would’ve
3. Creates plurals of letters and numbers
   - 3’s, B’S, 40’S

COLON:

1. **Introduces lists.**
   - The clock has three parts: a face, a dial and numbers.

COMMA,

1. **It used in a sentence to show that there should be a short pause before reading the next part of the sentence.**

- The party was good, I hope that we can have another one soon.

2. **It is also used to show a list of things in a sentence**.
    - We used them to build houses, fences, to make furniture utensils and tools.

FULL STOP .

Comes at the end of a sentence that is a statement.

- I was born in 1994.
- The pupils enjoyed themselves at the party.

QUESTION MARK?

The question mark comes at the end of a sentence that is a question.

- How old are you?
- When are we going for a holiday together?

EXCLAMATION MARK !

It is used to show strong feelings such as excitement, fear, shock, anger or surprise.

- Oh! Great!
- Wow! What a lovely dress.

QUOTATION MARKS " "

They are used in a sentence, to show the beginning and end of the exact of words spoken by the speaker.

- My aunt said to me, "you are the brightest niece I have."
- "Thank you very much for your time, "said Pheto.

VERBS

Verbs are words that describe action or the state of being.

ACTION AND LINKING VERBS

Action verbs describe activity. For example

Eat, leap, sleep, kick, run, walk, dream, yell, squat, cook, etc.

Action can also mean quieter activities like **care, forgive, hate, love, grow, concentrate etc.**

LINKING VERBS

Linking verbs do not describe action but a state of being. They connect a noun or adjective to the subject of a clause or sentence.

- Pitso **was** happy.
- The schools **are** closed.
- How **did** you finish the ride?

HELPING VERBS

Helping verbs help the main verb describe action that happened in the past, is happening in the present or will happen in the future. Examples of the 23 helping verbs are:

Am, are , be, been, being, can, could, did, do, does, has, had, have, is, may, might, must, shall, should, was, were, will, would.

EXERCISE

UNDERLINE HELPING VERBS IN SENTENCES BELOW

1. I am on holiday in Kasane.
2. It is lovely here.
3. They had a meeting on Monday.
4. My holiday was a bit boring
5. The baby is sleeping.

SYNONYMS

Synonyms are words that have similar meaning.

• Abandon – **leave**	• Abundant- **plenty**
• Accused – **blamed**	• Adhere- **stick**
• Affectionate- **loving**	• Afraid –**scared**
• Aid**- help**	• Afraid- **scared**
• Amazement- **wonder**	• Assemble**- begin**
• Beautiful **– loving**	• Caution- **care**
• Big- **huge/ large**	• Comprehend- **understand**
• Blank- **empty**	• Fall**- drop**

EXERCISE

MATCH THE WORDS IN COLUMN A WITH THEIR SYNONYMS IN COLUMN

COLUMN A	**COLUMN B**
1. Difficult	**A.** Slim
2. Profit	**B. guard**
3. Protect	**C.** Hard
4. Slender	**D.** Riches
5. Wealth	**E.** Unite
6. Unite	**F.** Govern
7. Rule	**G. Gain**

ANTONYMS

Words that have the same meaning. Examples of antonyms include:

- Adult – child
- Absent – present
- Answer- question
- Bad –good
- Brother – sister
- Difficult- easy
- East- west
- Entrance – exit
- Clean – dirty

EXERCISE

Give the opposite (antonyms) of the following words:

1. Big ----------
2. Hate ----------
3. Cruel _____
4. Empty _____
5. False _____
6. Expensive _____
7. Learn _____
8. Poor _____

HOMONYMS

Homonyms are words that have similar sounds, pronounced the same way yet they have different meanings.

EXAMPLES OF HOMONYMS

Aloud – **allowed** blew- **blue** check- **cheque** fool- **full** him **– hymn** knows- **nose**

Deer **– dear** meat **– meet** knew **– new** root- **route**

EXERCISE

CHOOSE THE CORRECT SOUNDING WORD TO MATCH EACH WORD

1. Ant----------(**hut, aunt**)
2. Fair----------(**fail, hair**)
3. Higher----------(**liar, hire**)
4. Hear----------(**ear, here**)
5. Hole----------(**whole, who**)
6. Flour----------(**floor, flower**)
7. Knight----------(**light, night**)
8. Rice----------(**rinse, rise**)

TERMS AND TECHNIQUES IN WRITING

ALLITERATION

Repetition of the same sound at the beginning of two or more words that are next to each other.

Examples

- Fly away, my fine- feathered friend.
- A silvery sliver slid from the needle case.

ASSONANCE

Vowel rhyme or words that have the same vowel sound. It is often used in poetry.

The sl**ow**ly gr**ow**ing mighty **oa**k did shade our h**o**me for years.

CLIMAX

The high point of a story. It is followed by an ending called a resolution.

DIALOGUE

Conversation or talking that takes place between two or more characters. Dialogue is usually enclosed in quotation marks.

HYPERBOLE

A deliberate exaggeration used as a figure of speech.

- **My dog is as big as a ten- ton elephant**
- **Their house was so big; you had to drive a car from the front door to the living room.**

IMAGERY

This is creating imaginary pictures using words. This is word painting and these pictures make certain points easier to understand and more interesting to read. Techniques such as **allusion**, **metaphor** and **simile** are examples of imagery.

- My dog is very happy (without imagery)

❖ My dog is a **pig in a mud (allusion)**

The boy would not sit down at the desk (without imagery)

❖ **The boy's desk might as well have been made of *pins and needles*. (metaphor)**

METAPHOR

A comparison of two different things to show a likeness between them that does not use ***like*** or ***as.***

❖ The teacher ***chimed*** the roll call.
❖ Peo was ***drowning in tears*** after her mother passed away.

ONOMATOPOEIA

Words that are invented to imitate real sounds. **Bang ,zip, smash, crunch, rip and grrrrr** are all examples of onomatopoeia.

PARABLE

A story with a moral or religious lesson to be learned. Parables are related to **fables.**

PERSONIFICATION

This means attributing to things that are not human the personalities and actions of human beings. Feelings can also be personified; for example **fear grabbed** the victim in its **icy clutches**.

SIMILE

A figure of speech that compares two unlike things using the words ***like*** or ***as***.

- The lion purred ***like*** a kitten.
- Tshepiso cried ***as*** if it were the end of the world.